

Apgar score	2	1	0
Skin color	Pink all over	Body pink; extremities blue	Pale/blue all over
Breathing	Regular strong cry	Irregular, weak cry	Absent
Pulse/heart rate	Greater than 100 bpm	Less than 100 bpm	Absent
Movements/muscle tone	Active	Moderate activity	Limp
Reflexes after given certain stimuli	Crying or grimacing strongly	Moderate reaction or grimace	No response

POSTPARTUM HEMORRHAGE

A postpartum hemorrhage (PPH) is the loss of more than 33 oz (1,000 ml) of blood after delivery of the baby. It can also be due to a retained placenta, when the placenta remains in the uterus for more than 30 minutes after delivery..

Risk factors include uterine fibroids, a previous delivery with PPH, multifetal gestation, a large baby, prolonged labor, or use of pitocin. If you have increased risk factors, then active management of the third stage is recommended. Improvements in the treatment of a PPH, with medications and new medical devices, have considerably reduced the complications.

YOUR BABY'S APPEARANCE

Newborn babies are usually surprisingly unattractive. Fortunately, as parents, we think they are beautiful. Newborns are covered in a waxy substance called vernix, together with amniotic fluid and blood from the birth canal. Babies who have passed meconium before the delivery may also have brown stained skin and nails.

In addition, newborn babies often have a molded, elongated head, with a swollen area on top known as a “caput,” which is due to the pressure on the baby’s head as it passes through the birth canal. Also, the nose may be squished to one side and the eyes may be swollen. Sometimes the genitals are swollen too. Rest assured that all of these features are temporary and within 24 hours or so the molding will work itself out and your baby will begin to look more like the baby you were expecting to meet.

No matter the race or ethnicity, all babies are born with purplish-red color skin. As the baby starts to breathe air, the blood vessels open up and gradually the skin color changes. This can take a day or two as the blood flow is prioritized to flow to the essential organs. Gradually the reddish-purple color fades. The blood vessels can be seen through the very thin newborn skin and the skin color is often pink. It is normal for the hands and feet to stay blue for several hours.

Healthy newborns have a range of skin tones in the first few days. The eventual color of the skin can take up to six months to develop and is determined by the rate of production of melanin.

Many babies are born with birthmarks, referred to as “stork bites.” These are red birthmarks on the eyelids and at the nape of the neck, which fade in time.